

which includes the file browser and the area to where you drag and drop the files to be burnt. A Wizard is conspicuously absent in the interface, but strictly speaking, Disc Master 2 doesn't need one.

## Performance

Memory usage was under 30 MB during the burn process, and Disc Master 2 (along with Power2Go) clocked the fastest time for burning a data disc.

Site: [http://intervideo.com/jsp/DiscMaster\\_Profile.jsp](http://intervideo.com/jsp/DiscMaster_Profile.jsp)

## NewTech InfoSystems NTI CD&DVD Maker 7

NTI CD&DVD Maker has always been known for its ease of use. The last time we did a review and comparison of burning software, NTI gave stiff competition to the then winner Nero 6 Ultra in the ease of use and features departments. Does it still stand up to the competition?



The interface of NTI CD&DVD Maker sports Mac OS-like skin and it was difficult to locate the Image burn task

## Features

It is hard to pinpoint a missing feature here. In the table you'll notice that CD&DVD Maker 7 gives Nero and Easy Media Creator a tough challenge. The only area it missed out on was in the ability to create a Music DVD. WMA music CDs are supported in CD&DVD Maker, though.

CD&DVD Maker is sparse in the additional package department; it bundled only the important applications—the AVI to MPEG converter, audio ripper, audio editor, and a few others.

## Ease Of Use

The interface bears a strong resemblance to Mac software. It is well supported by a simple Wizard that guides you through

all the steps necessary to burn your desired project. The only area where we had to work around a little bit with the interface was to burn a disc image. Otherwise, the interface is pretty straightforward, and so is the installation.

## Performance

CD&DVD Maker 7 did not impress us performance-wise. It taxes the system memory (albeit a little less than Nero does).

Site: [https://secure.ntius.com/esdsoft/cdmaker\\_v7\\_full.asp](https://secure.ntius.com/esdsoft/cdmaker_v7_full.asp)

## Sonic/Roxio Easy Media Creator 8

The dark horse in our comparison was Roxio's Easy Media Creator 8. Roxio has been bought over by Sonic Solutions, and the effect is showing up in this suite.

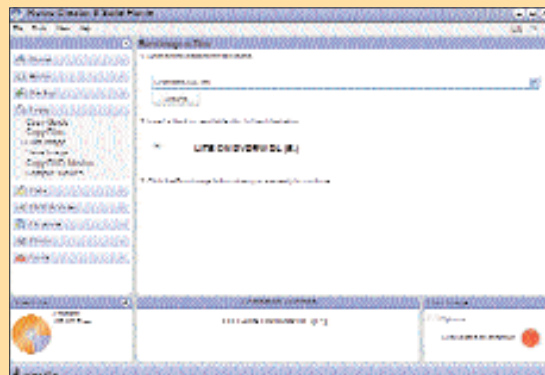
If you thought Nero was a complete solution, you might feel sorry for not having known about Easy Media Creator 8. But you can't be blamed; Sonic Solutions and Roxio do not provide a demo or a trial pack. All other manufacturers do.

## Features

What would you call a software that has all the features you'd want? We call it Easy Media Creator 8! This software is not only feature rich but also provides loads of additional packages. The only two areas we got a chance to type in "absent" in our comparison chart were Blu-Ray support and UPnP streaming... but do you really need these as of now?

## Ease Of Use

The installation Wizard is almost identical to that of Nero 7—you'll need to choose custom installa-



In Roxio Easy Media Creator 8, used disc space is shown as a shaded region on a disc symbol at the lower left corner

tion if you want to control the applications this mammoth product will add to your system.

The interface is fully backed by a Wizard that is integrated with the main application; it is not a separate dialog box guiding you through the various stages of a burn project. The left pane displays various categories under which different burn projects are classified. On the lower left corner, a disc icon shows the used disc space as a pie chart, and the estimated remaining space is displayed next to it.

## Performance

The application consumes about 100 MB of system memory when loading, and then settles down to 80-odd MB. But try burning a CD, and you'll see memory usage drop—sometimes it doesn't consume any! Even if Easy Media Creator uses virtual memory for its burning, it would probably just take a few extra seconds to burn a media—and you'll have free RAM to run other applications simultaneously.

Site: [www.roxio.com/en/products/index.jhtml](http://www.roxio.com/en/products/index.jhtml)

## Sonic/Roxio RecordNow! Deluxe 7

Looking for a software that is strictly meant for burning CDs and DVDs, and that doesn't load your system with packages you may never use? Sonic Solutions' RecordNow! Deluxe 7 is the answer: all it does is burn!

## Features

Most burning features are supported in RecordNow! Deluxe. But it lacks a little on the DVD burn features available in its cousin, Easy Media Creator 8. Other important features such as overburning, multi-session and image burning are supported.

In the additional package department, RecordNow! provided only basic, useful and frequently-used apps such as a CD label creator, audio ripping, and a Photo Slide Show disc wizard.

## Ease Of Use

We found the interface very compact and not very informative. It looks more like audio player software; the tabs on the base open up a hideable menu that reveals all the burn-related features. The tab classifies the